AI Marketing Trend Radar Guide

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The radar scans the last 7 days of news and conversation on your topic, ranks what matters to your audience, and hands you post angles in chat plus a branded page and PDF for your team. You choose the topic, the audience and the branding, so each course member ends up with their own version.

Getting started

1. **Upload the skill.** In Claude, open Settings, find Skills and choose Upload skill. Upload `SKILL.md`, or `ai-marketing-trend-radar.zip` if Claude asks for a zip. It installs as the `ai-marketing-trend-radar` skill.
2. **Optional: make a design system.** If you want the report in your brand, create a Claude design system first (colours, fonts, and your logo or photo in its assets). Without one the report uses a clean neutral look.
3. **Run setup.** Type `/ai-marketing-trend-radar set up the radar`. Claude asks for your topic, audience, region and which design system to use. It then builds the source lists, shows you a branded preview, and saves your settings into the skill.
4. **Run it weekly.** Type `/ai-marketing-trend-radar` whenever you want this week's report.

Setup takes about five minutes. You can rerun it any time to change the topic or the branding.

Running it

Type `/ai-marketing-trend-radar`, or ask in plain words. What you add after it decides the mode.

What you type	Mode	What happens
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar` or "what's trending this week"	Radar (default)	Scans your saved queries across all sources for your saved topic, ranks 5–8 trends
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar AI in healthcare`	Focused	Researches that topic for this run only, through your audience's lens, ranks 3–5 trends

What you type	Mode	What happens
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar Claude vs ChatGPT for marketers`	Comparison	Runs both sides plus the head-to-head, gives a verdict and content angles
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar set up the radar`	Setup	Asks for topic, audience, region and design system, previews the branding, saves your settings
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar brand it with my Acme design system`	Radar, one-off branding	Uses that design system for this run without changing your saved settings
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar run without apify`	Radar, web-search fallback	Skips the scrapers and uses web search for Reddit, X, YouTube and LinkedIn

The window is always the last 7 days, worked out from today's date. A run takes a few minutes because seven research agents search in parallel before anything is written.

What you get

Every run produces three outputs from the same data file, so they always match.

Output	Where it appears	Use it for
Full report	In the chat	Reading and copying hooks straight into drafts
Shareable page	A private link in your artifacts, updated at the same link on reruns in that chat	Sending to the team once you share it from its Share menu
A4 PDF	A file in the chat, named `ai-trend-radar-<date>.pdf`	Emailing, printing or dropping into Slack

Each trend carries:

- What happened and why B2B marketers should care
- The conversation, with verbatim quotes and who said them
- Three content angles (hot take, practical, contrarian), each with a suggested format
- How crowded the topic already is, and how long it stays fresh

The page and PDF add a stat tile row, the Trend Score ranking chart, a matrix of which sources each trend showed up in, and a chart of the week. They close with rising signals, a loud-but-skip list, the content plan table and sources.

After the report, ask for a LinkedIn post, a carousel, the newsletter's news section or a deeper look at any trend. Say what to change ("drop trend 5", "reword that hook") and it rebuilds the page and PDF together.

How trends are scored

The Trend Score (0–100) is a weighted sum of four parts, and the circle on each trend card shows it.

Part	Weight	Scores high when
Signal	35%	The top items have strong engagement and recency, and the trend appears in several sources (+10 for two, +20 for three or more)
Audience relevance	30%	It changes your audience's job this quarter (100); useful context scores 60, tangential 30
Content potential	25%	There is live debate (+30), a hard data point (+25), an angle not yet saturated on LinkedIn (+25), a practical hook (+20)
Momentum	10%	Most items are from the last 3 days (100); spread evenly 50; peaked early 20

The circle's shade reads the band: the darkest teal is 80 and above, mid teal 70–79, light teal below 70.

Items only count if they're dated inside the window. Recency inside the window weights newer items higher: 0–1 days scores 100, 2–3 days 85, 4–5 days 70, 6–7 days 55.

A trend needs at least two sources to rank. A single viral post goes under rising signals.

What it needs

Three things decide how complete a run is. Only the first costs money, and the radar still works without any of them.

Needs	Why	Without it
Apify connected (Reddit, X, YouTube and LinkedIn scrapers)	Real posts with engagement numbers, so scores reflect actual traction	Falls back to web search: Reddit is usually unreachable, X and YouTube lose engagement numbers, LinkedIn shows only a few posts from the current week
Your own Claude design system (optional)	Brands the page and PDF with your colours, fonts, logo or photo	Builds in the neutral theme; you can also give brand colours, fonts and a logo in chat instead
Python, Playwright with Chromium, npm	Builds the page and renders the PDF with your fonts embedded	Available by default in cloud sessions; the skill installs what's missing

Apify cost is roughly 30 to 60 US cents per radar run on the Starter plan. Treat that as an estimate until you've seen a real bill.

- [ ] Connect the Apify MCP server so runs have engagement data
- [ ] Create or check your Claude design system before running setup

Make it yours: topic and audience

Your topic and audience live in a Settings block at the top of the skill, and setup fills it in for you. Every run reads them, so the research, the relevance test and the angles all follow your choices.

Setting	What it controls	Example
`topic`	What the radar tracks by default	AI in financial services
`audience`, `audience_detail`	Who the content is for; drives "why it matters" and the angles	Compliance leaders at UK banks
`report_name`	The report's name on the page and PDF	FinServ AI Radar
`region`	Stories with this region's angle get flagged	UK
`voice`	How the chat report and hooks sound	Plain and measured, no hype

Setting	What it controls	Example
`queries`, `subreddits`, `trade_press`	Where it looks; setup generates these for your topic	r/fintech, finextra.com

To change one of these for good, run `/ai-marketing-trend-radar set up the radar` again, or ask Claude to change a single setting and save the skill. To change the topic for one run only, add it after the command.

Setup suggests queries and sources for your topic. Check that the subreddits and publications are ones your audience actually reads. Ask Claude to swap any that aren't.

Brand it with your design system

The report's layout stays the same for everyone; your design system supplies the colours, fonts and brand marks. Claude reads your design system, maps it onto the report and saves that mapping, so every week looks identical.

Which branding a run uses, first match wins:

1. A design system you name in the request ("brand it with my Acme design system")
2. The theme saved in your Settings by setup
3. The design system named in your Settings
4. Your own design systems: your default, or your only one; if you have several, Claude asks which
5. None: the neutral built-in look

What Claude takes from your design system:

Report element	Comes from
Page background, cards, borders	Your surface and border colours
Headlines, body text, labels	Your heading and body fonts and text colours
Accent band, score circles, links	Your primary colour, with darker and lighter steps for the score circles (80+, 70–79, below 70)
Chart colours	Four brand colours that are easy to tell apart
Chart of the week and footer	Your dark or inverse colour
Masthead byline and footer	Your logo, or your photo plus name; a small icon and link on the right, such as a newsletter

Report element	Comes from
Corners, uppercase labels, decorative strip	Your radius tokens and voice rules

Tips for a design system that brands well:

- Put your logo or photo in the design system's assets. If your logo only works on light backgrounds, add a reversed version too, or the footer shows your name in text instead.
- Use Google Fonts families, so the PDF can embed them.
- Describe what each colour is for. Claude maps colours by their descriptions, not just their names.
- Include a dark colour and a text colour that sits on your primary colour.

No design system? Tell Claude your brand colours (hex codes), a headline font, a body font, and attach your logo. It builds the theme from those.

The build checks the result and flags text that's too faint to read or chart colours that look alike, then Claude adjusts the theme before publishing. It has been tested on a serif editorial brand with a photo sign-off, and on a square-cornered corporate brand with one sans font and a logo.

Changing things

To change	Do this
Wording, a trend, the plan order in this week's report	Ask in the same chat; the page and PDF rebuild at the same link
The topic for one run	Add it after the command, e.g. `/ai-marketing-trend-radar AI in paid search`
Your default topic, audience, region or voice	Run setup again, or ask Claude to change that setting and save the skill
Queries, subreddits or trade press	Ask Claude to edit them in Settings and save the skill
Branding for one run	Name a design system in the request, or ask for a tweak ("darker accent")
Your saved branding	Run setup again after changing your design system, so the saved theme is re-mapped

To change	Do this
Scoring weights	Edit the weights in Step 4 and `WEIGHTS` in the builder script together

Saving works through Claude's skill review card. Where that isn't available, Claude gives you the updated SKILL.md file to replace your copy with.

Sharing the skill

There are two copies of the skill. Share the course copy with the course, never your personal one.

Copy	Settings inside	Use it for
Personal (the version you saved)	Your topic, your design system and your saved theme with your photo	Your own weekly runs
Course copy (`SKILL.md` , or `ai-marketing-trend-radar.zip`)	Default AI-for-marketing topic, no design system, no saved theme	Sharing: each person runs setup to make it theirs

If someone runs a copy that still points at a design system they can't open, the radar says so and falls back to their own design systems or the neutral look. Brand images never carry over from someone else's design system.

Limits

The radar reports only what it finds dated inside the 7-day window, so a quiet source means a thinner report, not invented filler.

- **Without Apify, scores are estimates.** Only Hacker News returns real engagement counts through the fallback, so the other parts of the score are judgement calls against the rules. The coverage note at the top of each report says when this applies.
- **LinkedIn lags.** Search engines index new LinkedIn posts slowly, so the fallback sees little from the current week. Saturation calls are weaker without the scraper.
- **Reddit needs Apify.** It blocks direct access from the cloud session.
- **UK and EU angles depend on the week.** The radar flags them when they appear but doesn't go looking for UK-only sources.
- **Check any number before you post it.** Every figure links back to its source in the report, and Hacker News counts pass through a summariser on the fallback route.

- **The page is private until you share it.** Use its Share menu before sending the link to the team. The PDF can go straight out.
- **Check the first branded preview.** Design systems name things differently, so the first mapping is a best reading of yours. Setup shows a preview before saving; ask for fixes then, and they're kept.
- **Topics far from tech get less from Hacker News.** That source stays in but may return little; the web and trade press carry more weight.